

INT. FAIRYTALE LAND - CASTLE DINING HALL - DINNER

We open on a grand dining hall where three people eat dinner together.

A KING, (50s), sits at the head of the table, and speaks with confidence and an air of self-righteousness.

KING MERAS

Today, I met with my advisors about building a new wing to this castle - what do you all think we should name it?

A QUEEN, (50s), sitting to King Meras's right, is kind, but knows how to get the best out of her husband.

QUEEN LILLIAN

I think naming it after someone in our lineage would be splendid, as long as that someone isn't you.

A PRINCESS, (20s), laughs, sitting opposite Queen Lillian. She has her mother's sense of humor, and her father's boldness.

PRINCESS SHELBY

Let's be fair, we've never named something after the best King this land was ruled by.

KING MERAS

Thank you, dear.

PRINCESS SHELBY

We should name it after mother's father.

The women laugh as King Meras sits there livid.

KING MERAS

What do you think, Damien?

We reveal that a fourth person has been eating with them quietly, on the left of Princess Shelby sits a KNIGHT, Damien, (20s), quiet, but only to mind his own business.

He looks up from his food, and speaks innocently.

DAMIEN

Maybe we could name it after one of the advisors. They've been with us for decades, haven't they?

QUEEN LILLIAN
He has a point.

KING MERAS
No, he doesn't. Castle's are named
after great rulers and fighters,
not something you would know.

Everyone falls silent at this remark.

DAMIEN
I'm sorry, father. I-

Suddenly, a DRAGON BURSTS into the HALL! It begins attacking
the family!

KING MERAS
SON! PICK UP YOUR SWORD AND FIGHT!

Damien, FROZEN, looks on into the terror that's happening.

He snaps back to reality, and immediately comes to his
father's aid. They try to fend off the Dragon with their
weapons, but it SPRAYS FIRE, destroying everything.

The CEILING comes CRASHING DOWN. Queen Lillian and Princess
Shelby try to get out of the way, but almost fall off what's
left of the hall.

KING MERAS (CONT'D)
GO HELP YOUR MOTHER AND SISTER!

Damien turns his attention, and he must make a choice. He
runs for his sister first!

He's able to grab her, but she SLIPS!

Damien backs away from the edge, horrified by what's just
happened.

Queen Lillian starts slipping as well, and King Meras takes a
beating from the Dragon! Damien is overwhelmed by the terror,
and incapable of dealing with it, HE RUNS AWAY!

INT. FAIRYTALE LAND - MAGIC FOREST - CONTINUOUS

Damien runs frantically, trying to forget the reality of what
just happened. He goes until he sees a figure in the
distance.

He stops to consider what he's about do, but continues
knowing it's his only option.

(O.S.)
I can't say this is a surprise.

DAMIEN
I have nothing else. My father once told me the magic of the wizard could be the only thing to help me become who I truly am.

The figure turns around to reveal A WIZARD, Dumbledore looking

THE WIZARD
Who might that be?

DAMIEN
I don't know. I only know I can't be what he wants me to be, and that means I can't be here anymore. Will you help me?

THE WIZARD
Hmm. I can take you to a place where you will see who you're truly meant to be.

DAMIEN
Do it please.

THE WIZARD
But, there will be a price.

DAMIEN
I will pay it, any cost.

THE WIZARD
Then, it is done. Your time here is over.

A billow of smoke, some magic dust, and POOF!

TITLE CARD - CHIVALRY'S NOT DEAD

INT. FOSTER HOME - ALEX'S BEDROOM - MORNING

ALEX, (middle school), a foster kid who's sure of herself, but not too sure of herself, is sitting up in bed reading a book.

She sets the book down on a nearby nightstand where we see the cover shows a knight fighting a dragon.

We catch a glimpse of the time - 6:59 AM - before it turns the hour and BRING!!!

All around the room are different foster kids who begin to stir from sleep, and before you know it, everyone is rushing to get ready.

Alex is reluctant to get out of bed and start the day, but she talks a minute to psych herself up.

ALEX
(to herself)
You can do this. New day means new
adventure. It's always an
adventure.

She finally gets out of bed to use the bathroom, but is blocked by three other people trying to use it at the same time - it's clear she's not familiar with them.

Annoyed, she waits her turn.

ALEX (CONT'D)
(to herself)
This is the lamest start to an
adventure ever.

INT. FOSTER HOME - FRONT DOOR - MOMENTS LATER

The kids walk out to get on the bus, but Alex is held back by TESS, (30s), - their caring, but spread thin foster mom.

TESS
How are you feeling, hon?

ALEX
Fine.

TESS
Alright, well you tell me if
there's anything I can do to make
you feel more at home. Go on now,
don't be late.

Alex shrugs this off and gets on the bus.

INT. BUS - CONTINUOUS

Alex finds her way down the aisle and plops herself next to CORY, (middle school), a sweet and curious boy the same age as Alex, and her best friend.

CORY
Hey! Everything alright?

ALEX
Everything, but having to learn
eight new names this week.

CORY
Well what's your new foster mom's
name?

ALEX
Tess. She's-

CORY
That's pretty! She sounds like
someone who cares very much about
you and will always keep you safe!

ALEX
Well, she act likes someone who
doesn't care that much and is just
doing a job.

CORY
C'mon Alex, you just have to give
her a chance. They could be the
one.

ALEX
There's not going to be a one,
Cory, and it's really okay.

CORY
At least school will be fun!

Alex lets out a guttural sigh.

CORY (CONT'D)
Did you bring them?

ALEX
Do you think I could survive
without them?

Alex unzips her backpack and pulls out FAIRY TALE BOOKS.

Cory grabs them and looks through the titles.

CORY
Ooo, mermaid princess! The one with
the beanstalk is great! Rumpel.. I
don't know how to say that, but
it's looks cool-

ALEX

Ya, that's new! I just thought it
looked funny.
(giggles)

CORY

And- why is Damien one here?

ALEX

I like that one! I don't know, it
just never gets old for me.

CORY

So you'll come over after school?

ALEX

If I can make it through class with
Ms. Lily.

INT. SCHOOL - HOME ROOM - MIDDLE OF THE SCHOOL DAY

MS. LILY, (30s), a soft-spoken and positive woman, is at the front of the room talking to the class.

She's teaching a history lesson, which we can see by the title and related on information written on the board behind her.

MS. LILY

So, in America, we'd say the leader
of our country is The President.
But, he doesn't get to choose all
the rules. Our country runs on
something called Democracy which
is...

The lecture fades into noise briefly as we notice that Alex is in her own world, nose buried in her desk.

She sketches away in a notebook already filled with lots of sketches of fairy tale characters.

MS. LILY (CONT'D)

A country like England, for
example, is lead by a King and a
Queen. Can anyone tell me what
that's called? Alex?

Alex's head shoots up, her face blank, but pencil still in hand.

Ms. Lily stares persistently and Alex looks to Cory for help.

Cory tries to mouth the word "Monarchy".

ALEX
A... Monopoly?

The class laughs, and Alex sulks back into her notebook.

RING!! The period is over.

MS. LILY
That's lunch! Don't forget when you go home to remind your parents tomorrow is 'Bring your parent to school day' and we're having presentations in this classroom!

Most of the class clears out.

Cory walks over to Alex who's still hiding her face, and pats her for comfort.

Ms. Lily walks over too.

MS. LILY (CONT'D)
Alex, dear, what happened today?

ALEX
(throws her hands up)
I'm just stupid!

MS. LILY
I know you're a bright girl. All I see you and Cory do during break is read, and that's amazing! But when you're in class, you need to get your head out of the fairy tales.
(she points at the sketches)
Can you try that for me?

ALEX
Yeah, I'll try.

MS. LILY
Great. Will you be bringing someone to class tomorrow?

ALEX
I don't think so, I don't really have anyone to-

CORY
You could ask Tess! She's her new foster mom.

Alex shoots him a look of resistance.

INT. SCHOOL - HALLWAY - MOMENTS LATER

Alex and Cory head from class to the lunchroom.

ALEX

That really wasn't cool, Cory. I don't feel like Tess will even care to go.

CORY

She will too! You just gotta give her the chance! Don't you want to know if she could come with you?

ALEX

I guess. I'll ask, fine.

CORY

Awesome! I really hope there's corn in the cafeteria today.

As they're walking, a trio of boys from class confront Alex.

CHASE and ETHAN, are lead by JACK (all same age)- Alex's bullies who just love being the brats they are.

JACK

You were funny in there, Alex. It's always funny when you try to answer questions in class, actually.

The boys snicker.

ALEX

Ya? I think it's funny when you're face shows up in class.

CHASE

Your face looks stupider than his!

ALEX

It's still smarter than your brain.

JACK

At least my face is loved by two parents.

This shuts Alex up.

CORY

That's not funny.

ETHAN

Your face is funny too, Cory.

CORY

Whatever, just leave us alone.

JACK

Can't wait to see who you show up
with tomorrow, Alex!

The trio strides off, triumphant.

Alex is hurting, and Cory tries to comfort her.

CORY

Forget those idiots, they're just
being mean. You're way smarter than
them.

ALEX

Thanks Cory, but they're right.

CORY

What? The face thing? Your face is
better looking than theirs, trust
me.

ALEX

(laughs)

No, I just mean, ugghhh. I wish
someone could be there for me
tomorrow. I really hope, Tess says
yes.

CORY

She will, I just know it!

INT. CORY'S HOUSE - CORY'S BASEMENT - AFTER SCHOOL

Alex and Cory arrive at the bottom of the stairs and drop
their backpacks on a nearby couch.

ALEX

Can I use your phone? I have to
tell Tess that I'm staying here
tonight.

Cory dashes back up the stairs.

Alex plops down on the couch and decides to go through her
fairy tale books.

She pulls out the one with Damien and flips through.

We land on a page that sees Damien being embraced by a king and queen. Alex stares at this page.

Cory comes back down with a phone in hand, which he gives to Alex. Alex dials a number and waits.

TESS (V.O.)

Hello?

ALEX

Hey Tess, it's Alex. I'm calling from Cory's home phone. We- I wanted to have a sleepover tonight, if that's ok.

TESS (V.O.)

Did his mom say it's ok?

ALEX

Yeah, we just asked, she doesn't mind.

TESS (V.O.)

Alright, I can pick you up in the morning. Have fun-

ALEX

Actually, I wanted to ask you something... my teacher said tomorrow was 'Bring your parents to school day' and I don't have parents obviously, but I thought it would be okay if you came with me, so I was wondering... could you?

TESS (V.O.)

Oh Alex, I'd really love to, but you know I have a responsibility to stay at home and take care of some of the younger kids with us, so I can't really leave, I'm so sorry.

The line goes quiet for a minute as Alex absorbs this.

ALEX

It's fine, it really is. I'll see you tomorrow.

Alex hangs up without waiting for a response. She sits back, reeling.

Cory looks on sympathetically.